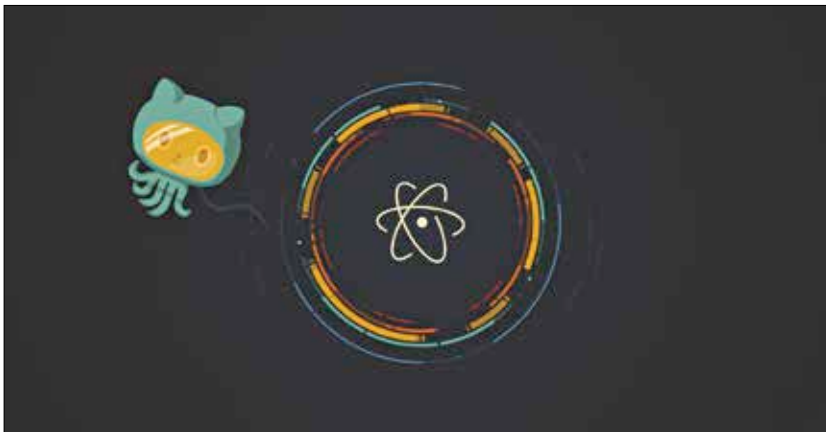




Atom

A customisable and versatile text editor

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Atom is a free and open source text editor, a project started and maintained by GitHub. The text editor is actually built on top of Chromium, which is the open source project on top of which Google builds the Chrome browser. An atom window is technically speaking a web page that is hosted and rendered on the machine itself. This means that there is a lot of room to tinker and fiddle around with it, including support for plugins and themes. If there is something that you want but is not available on Atom, chances are someone has written a package for it, or you can do it yourself, using Atom as the tool to do so. While there are some text editors such as Textmate or Notepad++ that are very approachable, they are not too customisable, while others such as XEmacs or Vim are extensible, but not very easy to use. Atom is both very flexible, and very accessible. The great thing is that the interface is instantly familiar, and there are tabs available for you to work with, which is very much like using the Chrome browser. Those working with HTML, CSS, XML, Javascript or C++ stand to benefit from using Atom,

because of the sheer convenience and the thoughtful features on offer. A team of people use Atom can collaborate on a project using Teletype. If you are a keyboard warrior, then Atom is the text editor for you because it has been designed to not require the mouse for using it at all. The brilliance of Atom is the many, many ways in which it makes things faster than even copy pasting code! If you have been defaulting to Notepad++ all these years, then Atom is the perfect replacement.

HIGHLIGHT THE SYNTAX

Normally Atom does a good job of understanding which syntax is being used, and does a good job of highlighting the text blocks. However, if you create a new blank document, paste the code in, then everything may just be a wall of

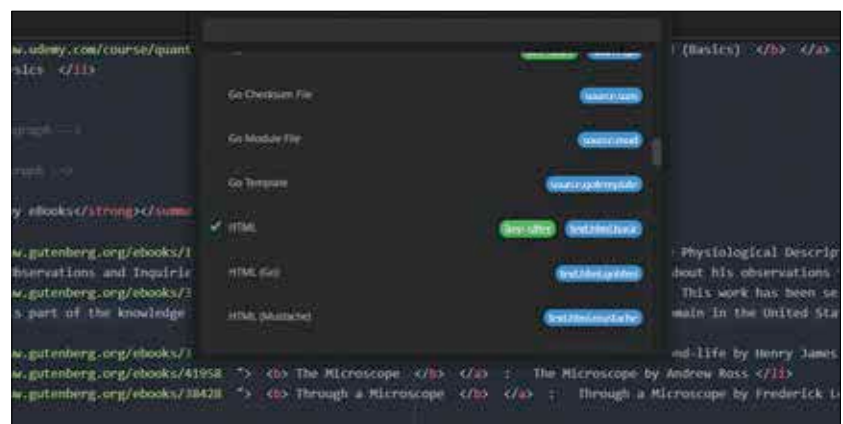
grey text. To colorize the text so that the document is easier to navigate, you need to select the appropriate language. To do this, either press `ctrl+shift+l`, or navigate to the character encoding and syntax options towards the bottom right of the window, and select the appropriate syntax. The auto detect button generally does a great job, but there is also an option to search for a particular syntax, or you can just scroll through the document and pick from one of the exhaustive options. You will be hard pressed to find a syntax that is not supported, and even then there are workarounds. For example, the C++ syntax works perfectly for highlighting the necessary bits when working with Unity shaders.

CONVERT CASE

This is a nifty little trick that you might find yourself needing in various circumstances. The case for the document may be all wrong. Atom provides an easy way to convert text from lowercase to uppercase and vice versa. Just select the text that you want to convert, then go to `Edit > Text` and then select either the Lower Case or Upper Case, depending on the case. To do this using keyboard shortcuts, navigate the cursor just before the word that you want to change, or highlight the text, then press `Ctrl + K Ctrl + U` for uppercase or `Ctrl + K Ctrl + L` for lowercase. In these shortcuts, you can keep the `Ctrl` key pressed, while typing `K` and `U` in succession, to convert lowercase to uppercase.

MULTI CURSOR

This nifty little feature is something that promises to save considerable amount of time over projects. Atom supports



Highlighting syntax in the appropriate colours